

Easy Way Out

Windows XP offers you a Sound Troubleshooter, which takes you through a step-by-step solution to your problem.

Getting to the Sound Troubleshooter:

1. Go to Start > Help and Support
2. Under "Pick a help topic", choose Fixing a Problem
3. In the next screen, choose Game, Sound and Video Problems, and select Sound Troubleshooter on the right side of the window.

More often than not, if your problem is minor, the Troubleshooter proves quite handy to solve it.

4.1 Deathly Silence

You've begged and pleaded and prayed and cried, but still can't get a beep out of your system? Let's take a look.

Speaker Woes

Before anything else, check if your speakers are all right. Plug them into a power socket, and see if they're linked in properly. Use any type of audio device — portable or otherwise, to check if your speakers work with those. If they don't, it's probably time to get some new speakers.

Now make sure the speakers are connected properly. This rarely happens with 2 or 2.1 speaker systems (with all the colour codes and only one connection to make), but it's easy to go wrong with a multi-channel speaker system. Read the manual that came with your speakers to make sure you've plugged them in right.

If you're trying to use a multi-channel (say, a 5.1) speaker system with an onboard sound card, using the microphone and line-in jacks as output sound channels, make sure that the sound chipset on your motherboard supports being used that way (Line out for Front, Line In for Rear and Microphone In for Centre). To